What Am I Trying Never to Face?

What am I treating as something that must never happen?

READING

Epictetus, *Enchiridion* 2; Seneca, *Letters* 18.5–8. Epictetus redirects aversion toward misusing our own choice. Seneca rehearses simple living to examine dependence on comfort and wealth. This modern adaptation uses a modest, safe inconvenience to inspect what we think we need.

BEFORE THE MEETING

Announce on your Substack. Say the topic includes fear, comfort, and dependence. Nobody must disclose a loss or undertake discomfort. Bring the reading links.

Open · 10	Read · 10	Discuss · 45	Practice · 15	Close · 10
Welcome; anyone may pass	Aloud, together	The questions below	Test a small supposed necessity	One takeaway each

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. What inconvenience do you work hard to prevent? What would facing it seem to mean?
2. When does sensible avoidance become a demand for complete protection from difficulty?
3. What might going briefly without a convenience reveal that thinking alone misses?
4. How can knowing life is finite clarify what is worth wanting without making us gloomy?
5. In difficulty, what misuse of your own choice deserves more concern than discomfort?

PRACTICE THIS MONTH

Examine one aversion. Name what you want to avoid and why escape seems necessary. If suitable, try one harmless inconvenience, such as setting aside entertainment while waiting, and notice what it reveals about dependence. A recent unavoidable one works as well; no endurance contest is needed.

FACILITATOR'S MOVE

"What are we testing?" Keep the focus on valuation. Choose ordinary discomfort that fits health and responsibilities; there is no need for deprivation or proof of toughness.

NOTES